

I Bind Unto Myself Today

Words: attributed to St. Patrick of Ireland (circa 387-466). Paraphrased by Cecil F. Alexander, 1889.
Music: 'St. Patricks Breastplate' Charles V. Stanford, 1902. Setting: "The English Hymnal", 1906.
copyright: public domain. This score is a part of the Open Hymnal Project, 2006 Revision.

♩ = 120

The musical score is written for a four-part vocal choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. The key signature is three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat) and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 120. The score consists of three systems of music. The first system contains the first five lines of the hymn, with the piano accompaniment in the lower staves. The second system contains the next five lines, with the piano accompaniment in the lower staves. The third system contains the final five lines, with the piano accompaniment in the lower staves. The lyrics are written below the vocal staves, and the piano accompaniment is written in the lower staves.

1. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The strong Name of the
2. I bind this day to me for - - ev - er By pow - er of faith, Christ's
3. I bind un - to my - self the pow - er Of the great love of
4. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The vir - - tues of the
5. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The pow - er of God to

Tri - - ni - - ty,
in - - car - - na - - tion;
cher - - u - - bim;
star lit heav - - en,
hold and lead,

By in - - vo - - ca - - tion
His bap - - tism in the
The sweet "Well done" in
The glor - - ious sun's life
His eye to watch, His

The first system of music consists of three staves. The top staff is a vocal line in treble clef, starting with a half note G4, followed by quarter notes A4, Bb4, and A4, then a half note G4. The piano accompaniment is in the bottom two staves (treble and bass clefs). The right hand plays chords and moving lines, while the left hand plays a steady bass line with chords.

The second system continues the musical piece. The vocal line has a first ending bracket labeled '1' over a half note G4. The piano accompaniment continues with chords and moving lines in both hands.

The third system includes lyrics for the vocal line. The lyrics are: "same", "riv", "ho", "ray,", "stay,", "er,", "ur,". The vocal line has a second ending bracket labeled "2-9" over a half note G4. The piano accompaniment continues with chords and moving lines in both hands.

The first system of music consists of a vocal line and a piano accompaniment. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The vocal line begins with a whole note on G4. The piano accompaniment consists of a single chord (F4, A4, Bb4) in the right hand and a single note (Bb3) in the left hand.

The second system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note on G4, followed by a quarter note on A4, and then a half note on Bb4. The piano accompaniment features a series of chords and moving lines in both hands, including a descending scale in the right hand.

The third system of music includes a vocal line and a piano accompaniment. The vocal line has a half note on G4, followed by a quarter note on A4, and then a half note on Bb4. The piano accompaniment features a series of chords and moving lines in both hands, including a descending scale in the right hand.

2. His burst - - - ing from the
3. Con - - - fes - - - sors' faith, A - -
4. The flash - - - ing of of the
5. The wis - - - dom of my

The fourth system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note on G4, followed by a quarter note on A4, and then a half note on Bb4. The piano accompaniment features a series of chords and moving lines in both hands, including a descending scale in the right hand.

up - pray - ers, the heav'n - ly way, His com - - ing
the the pro - - phets' scrolls, All good deeds
wind's tem - - pest - - uous shocks, The sta - - ble
guide, His shield to ward; The word of

6. Against the demon snares of sin,
The vice that gives temptation force,
The natural lusts that war within,
The hostile men that mar my course;
Or few or many, far or nigh,
In every place and in all hours,
Against their fierce hostility
I bind to me these holy powers.

8. Christ be with me, Christ within me,
Christ behind me, Christ before me,
Christ beside me, Christ to win me,
Christ to comfort and restore me.
Christ beneath me, Christ above me,
Christ in quiet, Christ in danger,
Christ in hearts of all that love me,
Christ in mouth of friend and stranger.

7. Against all Satan's spells and wiles,
Against false words of heresy,
Against the knowledge that defiles,
Against the heart's idolatry,
Against the wizard's evil craft,
Against the death wound and the burning,
The choking wave, the poisoned shaft,
Protect me, Christ, till Thy returning.

9. I bind unto myself the Name,
The strong Name of the Trinity,
By invocation of the same,
The Three in One and One in Three.
By Whom all nature hath creation,
Eternal Father, Spirit, Word:
Praise to the Lord of my salvation,
Salvation is of Christ the Lord.